

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

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EVALUATOR:

DATE:

PRODUCT:

TASK:

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

1. The loading screen does not show how long it will load.
2. Users may not know if changes are saved.

Recommendations

1. Add a loading animation or progress indicator.
2. Add status feedback after actions.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

1. "Missed Tasks" sounds negative
2. Some labels may confuse first-time users

Recommendations

1. Change to "Pending Tasks"
2. Use simpler and more familiar words

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

1. There is no Undo button after deleting or editing tasks.
2. Navigation between pages may confuse users.

Recommendations

1. Add Undo and Cancel buttons.
2. Add clearer navigation icons

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

1. Some pages may have different layouts.
2. Icons and buttons may not look similar on every page.
3. Some text sizes may vary

Recommendations

1. Keep the design and spacing consistent
2. Use the same button and icon styles throughout the app
3. Standardize typography

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Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

1. Users may add incomplete tasks
2. Users can enter unrealistic study times.

Recommendations

1. Make important fields required
2. Add limits or suggestions for study duration

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

1. Users may forget previously added tasks
2. Important options may not always be visible
3. New users may not understand all features

Recommendations

1. Add recent tasks or history section
2. Make important buttons easier to find
3. Add tooltips or short guides

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Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

1. Adding tasks may take too many steps
2. Users always need to manually set study time
3. No shortcuts for experienced users

Recommendations

1. Add quick-add task feature
2. Add preset time options
3. Add easier navigation tabs.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

1. Some pages may look crowded
2. Progress page may contain too much information
3. Important information may not stand out

Recommendations

1. Reduce unnecessary elements
2. Organize information using cards or sections
3. Improve font sizes and spacing

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Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

1. No clear error messages for invalid input
2. Users may not know how to fix mistakes
3. No retry options after failed actions

Recommendations

1. Add simple and understandable error messages.
2. Provide suggestions when errors happen
3. Add retry or edit options.

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

1. No help section for new users/
2. Users may not understand some features.
3. No guidance during task creation.

Recommendations

1. Add tutorials.
2. Add help icons or instructions.
3. Add hints or examples